



AP English Language and Composition Skills

BIG IDEAS							
RHS Rhetorical Situation		CLE Claims and Evidence		REO Reasoning and Organization		STL Style	
ENDURING UNDERSTANDINGS							
Individuals write within a particular situation and make strategic writing choices based on that situation.		Writers make claims about subjects, rely on evidence that supports the reasoning that justifies the claim, and often acknowledge or respond to other, possibly opposing, arguments.		Writers guide understanding of a text's lines of reasoning and claims through that text's organization and integration of evidence.		The rhetorical situation informs the strategic stylistic choices that writers make.	
Skill Category 1	Skill Category 2	Skill Category 3	Skill Category 4	Skill Category 5	Skill Category 6	Skill Category 7	Skill Category 8
Rhetorical Situation – Reading Explain how writers' choices reflect the components of the rhetorical situation.	Rhetorical Situation – Writing Make strategic choices in a text to address a rhetorical situation.	Claims and Evidence – Reading Identify and describe the claims and evidence of an argument.	Claims and Evidence – Writing Analyze and select evidence to develop and refine a claim.	Reasoning and Organization – Reading Describe the reasoning, organization, and development of an argument.	Reasoning and Organization – Writing Use organization and commentary to illuminate the line of reasoning in an argument.	Style – Reading Explain how writers' stylistic choices contribute to the purpose of an argument.	Style – Writing Select words and use elements of composition to advance an argument.
SKILLS							
1.A Identify and describe components of the rhetorical situation: the exigence, audience, writer, purpose, context, and message. Units 1, 4, 7	2.A Write introductions and conclusions appropriate to the purpose and context of the rhetorical situation. Units 4, 7	3.A Identify and explain claims and evidence within an argument. Units 1, 2, 3, 6	4.A Develop a paragraph that includes a claim and evidence supporting the claim. Units 1, 2, 3, 6	5.A Describe the line of reasoning and explain whether it supports an argument's overarching thesis. Unit 3, 5	6.A Develop a line of reasoning and commentary that explains it throughout an argument. Units 3, 5	7.A Explain how word choice, comparisons, and syntax contribute to the specific tone or style of a text. Units 5, 6, 8	8.A Strategically use words, comparisons, and syntax to convey a specific tone or style in an argument. Units 5, 6, 8
1.B Explain how an argument demonstrates understanding of an audience's beliefs, values, or needs. Units 2, 8	2.B Demonstrate an understanding of an audience's beliefs, values, or needs. Units 2, 8	3.B Identify and describe the overarching thesis of an argument, and any indication it provides of the argument's structure. Units 2, 4, 6	4.B Write a thesis statement that requires proof or defense and that may preview the structure of the argument. Unit 2, 4, 6	5.B Explain how the organization of a text creates unity and coherence and reflects a line of reasoning. Unit 5	6.B Use transitional elements to guide the reader through the line of reasoning of an argument. Unit 5	7.B Explain how writers create, combine, and place independent and dependent clauses to show relationships between and among ideas. Units 7, 8	8.B Write sentences that clearly convey ideas and arguments. Units 7, 8
		3.C Explain ways claims are qualified through modifiers, counterarguments, and alternative perspectives. Units 7, 9	4.C Qualify a claim using modifiers, counterarguments, or alternative perspectives. Units 7, 9	5.C Recognize and explain the use of methods of development to accomplish a purpose. Units 3, 4	6.C Use appropriate methods of development to advance an argument. Units 3, 4	7.C Explain how grammar and mechanics contribute to the clarity and effectiveness of an argument. Unit 7	8.C Use established conventions of grammar and mechanics to communicate clearly and effectively. Unit 7

Course at a Glance

Plan

The Course at a Glance provides a useful visual organization of the AP English Language and Composition curricular components, including:

- Sequence of units, along with suggested pacing. Please note that pacing is based on 45-minute class periods, meeting five days each week, for a full academic year.
- Progression of skills within each unit.
- Spiraling of the big ideas and skills across units.

Teach

BIG IDEAS/SKILL CATEGORIES
Big ideas and their skills spiral across units.

RHS Rhetorical Situation	REO Reasoning and Organization
CLE Claims and Evidence	STL Style

Assess

Assign the Personal Progress Checks—either as homework or in class—for each unit. Each Personal Progress Check contains formative multiple-choice and free-response questions. The feedback from the Personal Progress Checks shows students the areas where they need to focus.

Unit 1: _____

~15 Class Periods

RHS	1.A Identify and describe components of the rhetorical situation: the exigence, audience, writer, purpose, context, and message.
CLE	3.A Identify and explain claims and evidence within an argument.
CLE	4.A Develop a paragraph that includes a claim and evidence supporting the claim.

Unit 2: _____

~15 Class Periods

RHS	1.B Explain how an argument demonstrates understanding of an audience's beliefs, values, or needs.
RHS	2.B Demonstrate an understanding of an audience's beliefs, values, or needs.
CLE	3.A Identify and explain claims and evidence within an argument.
CLE	4.A Develop a paragraph that includes a claim and evidence supporting the claim.
CLE	3.B Identify and describe the overarching thesis of an argument, and any indication it provides of the argument's structure.
CLE	4.B Write a thesis statement that requires proof or defense and that may preview the structure of the argument.

Personal Progress Check 1

ONLINE ONLY
Multiple-choice: ~10 questions
ONLINE OR PAPER
Free-response: 1 question

Personal Progress Check 2

ONLINE ONLY
Multiple-choice: ~20 questions
ONLINE OR PAPER
Free-response: 1 question

Unit 3: _____

~15 Class Periods

- | | |
|------------|---|
| CLE | 3.A Identify and explain claims and evidence within an argument. |
| CLE | 4.A Develop a paragraph that includes a claim and evidence supporting the claim. |
| REO | 5.A Describe the line of reasoning and explain whether it supports an argument's overarching thesis. |
| REO | 6.A Develop a line of reasoning and commentary that explains it throughout an argument. |
| REO | 5.C Recognize and explain the use of methods of development to accomplish a purpose. |
| REO | 6.C Use appropriate methods of development to advance an argument. |

Personal Progress Check 3

ONLINE ONLY

Multiple-choice: ~20 questions

ONLINE OR PAPER

Free-response: 1 question

Unit 4: _____

~15 Class Periods

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|------------|---|
| RHS | 1.A Identify and describe components of the rhetorical situation: the exigence, audience, writer, purpose, context, and message. |
| RHS | 2.A Write introductions and conclusions appropriate to the purpose and context of the rhetorical situation. |
| CLE | 3.B Identify and describe the overarching thesis of an argument, and any indication it provides of the argument's structure. |
| CLE | 4.B Write a thesis statement that requires proof or defense and that may preview the structure of the argument. |
| REO | 5.C Recognize and explain the use of methods of development to accomplish a purpose. |
| REO | 6.C Use appropriate methods of development to advance an argument. |

Personal Progress Check 4

ONLINE ONLY

Multiple-choice: ~20 questions

ONLINE OR PAPER

Free-response: 1 question

Unit 5: _____

~15 Class Periods

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|------------|---|
| REO | 5.A Describe the line of reasoning and explain whether it supports an argument's overarching thesis. |
| REO | 6.A Develop a line of reasoning and commentary that explains it throughout an argument. |
| REO | 5.B Explain how the organization of a text creates unity and coherence and reflects a line of reasoning. |
| REO | 6.B Use transitional elements to guide the reader through the line of reasoning of an argument. |
| STL | 7.A Explain how word choice, comparisons, and syntax contribute to the specific tone or style of a text. |
| STL | 8.A Strategically use words, comparisons, and syntax to convey a specific tone or style in an argument. |

Personal Progress Check 5

ONLINE ONLY

Multiple-choice: ~20 questions

ONLINE OR PAPER

Free-response: 1 question

Unit 6: _____

~15 Class Periods

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|------------|---|
| CLE | 3.A Identify and explain claims and evidence within an argument. |
| CLE | 4.A Develop a paragraph that includes a claim and evidence supporting the claim. |
| CLE | 3.B Identify and describe the overarching thesis of an argument, and any indication it provides of the argument's structure. |
| CLE | 4.B Write a thesis statement that requires proof or defense and that may preview the structure of the argument. |
| STL | 7.A Explain how word choice, comparisons, and syntax contribute to the specific tone or style of a text. |
| STL | 8.A Strategically use words, comparisons, and syntax to convey a specific tone or style in an argument. |

Personal Progress Check 6

ONLINE ONLY

Multiple-choice: ~20 questions

ONLINE OR PAPER

Free-response: 1 question

Unit 7: _____

~15 Class Periods

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|------------|--|
| RHS | 1.A Identify and describe components of the rhetorical situation: the exigence, audience, writer, purpose, context, and message. |
| RHS | 2.A Write introductions and conclusions appropriate to the purpose and context of the rhetorical situation. |
| CLE | 3.C Explain ways claims are qualified through modifiers, counterarguments, and alternative perspectives. |
| CLE | 4.C Qualify a claim using modifiers, counterarguments, or alternative perspectives. |
| STL | 7.B Explain how writers create, combine, and place independent and dependent clauses to show relationships between and among ideas. |
| STL | 8.B Write sentences that clearly convey ideas and arguments. |
| STL | 7.C Explain how grammar and mechanics contribute to the clarity and effectiveness of an argument. |
| STL | 8.C Use established conventions of grammar and mechanics to communicate clearly and effectively. |

Personal Progress Check 7

ONLINE ONLY

Multiple-choice: ~20 questions

ONLINE OR PAPER

Free-response: 1 question

Unit 8: _____

~15 Class Periods

- | | |
|------------|--|
| RHS | 1.B Explain how an argument demonstrates understanding of an audience's beliefs, values, or needs. |
| RHS | 2.B Demonstrate an understanding of an audience's beliefs, values, or needs. |
| STL | 7.A Explain how word choice, comparisons, and syntax contribute to the specific tone or style of a text. |
| STL | 8.A Strategically use words, comparisons, and syntax to convey a specific tone or style in an argument. |
| STL | 7.B Explain how writers create, combine, and place independent and dependent clauses to show relationships between and among ideas. |
| STL | 8.B Write sentences that clearly convey ideas and arguments. |

Personal Progress Check 8

ONLINE ONLY

Multiple-choice: ~20 questions

ONLINE OR PAPER

Free-response: 1 question

Unit 9: _____

~15 Class Periods

CLE **3.C** Explain ways claims are qualified through modifiers, counterarguments, and alternative perspectives.

CLE **4.C** Qualify a claim using modifiers, counterarguments, or alternative perspectives.

Personal Progress Check 9

ONLINE ONLY

Multiple-choice: ~5 questions

ONLINE OR PAPER

Free-response: 1 question